4.16 Peripheral Arterial Disease*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My calf hurts when I walk and stops when I rest." **Objective** • Weak pedal pulses • Cool, shiny, hairless skin on the legs • Slow capillary refill	**ACTUAL** Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion related to arterial narrowing as evidenced by claudication, weak pulses and trophic skin changes.	• Walks further before pain starts within 4 weeks.	• Check pulses, color and temperature of the legs. • Encourage a graded walking program. • Keep the legs level or dependent, not raised. • Support smoking cessation. • Give antiplatelet and statin therapy as prescribed.	• Achieved as walking distance increases.
Subjective • Rates leg pain 6/10 on walking **Objective** • Claudication after 100 meters • Weak pedal pulses	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to ischemia as evidenced by claudication.	• Pain manageable during activity.	• Teach him to walk until pain begins, rest, then carry on. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Encourage a supervised exercise program. • Support smoking cessation.	• Outcome reached when pain is manageable.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Poor peripheral circulation • Diabetes mellitus	**RISK** Risk for impaired skin integrity as evidenced by risk factors: impaired circulation.	• Skin of the feet stays intact.	• Teach daily foot inspection. • Advise suitable footwear. • Avoid heating pads on the legs.	• Considered met if the skin remains intact.

* **References for this care plan:** [30], [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.